Extraction of Quantum Circuit Images

Khushalkumar Jitendrabhai Variya, k.variya@oth-aw.de[1]

[1]*OTH Amberg-Weiden, Study programme "Artificial Intelligence for Industrial Applications"*

Abstract

Quantum computing research is growing quickly, resulting in a vast amount of scientific literature. Locating specific visual elements, such as quantum circuit diagrams, in these documents can be difficult. Many papers have similar keywords and technical styles. This report describes a system designed to find and extract these circuit images from a large set of PDFs.

The system combines Natural Language Processing (NLP) to analyze the surrounding text for relevant keywords like "qubit" or "gate" with Computer Vision (CV) techniques to examine the visual structure of the images. This dual-filter approach helps separate actual circuits from other common graphics, such as hardware diagrams, charts, and plots. In this report, I explain how I developed the filtering pipeline, the challenges posed by similar content, and the final results of my image extraction process.

Keywords: *Quantum Circuits, Image Extraction, NLP, Computer Vision, Document Analysis*

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1. Introduction

1.1. Motivation: The Data Gap in Quantum Machine Learning

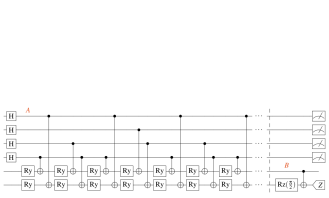
During the past few years, quantum computing [7], [19] has been expanding at a nonstop pace. Thousands of papers are published every month by researchers around the world on platforms like arXiv [28], sharing new algorithms and hardware innovations. For anyone involved in research or study in this field, the rapid pace of these developments is a huge barrier to staying up-to-date with new knowledge. One particular issue is the visualization of visual content, particularly quantum circuit diagrams [16]. These diagrams are the "blueprints" of quantum algorithms implemented in frameworks like Qiskit [31] and Cirq [24], and it would be very convenient if one could automatically discover them within thousands of PDFs from which to create large step-based datasets or summary reports.

1.2. Problem Statement: Unstructured Graphical Data in PDFs

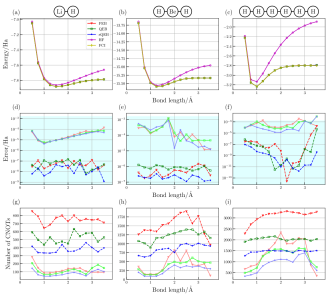
The most peculiar challenge of obtaining quantum circuits is the similarity in visualization and in the language used to describe these diverse figures. Quantum research papers often contain not just circuits, but hardware schematics, pulse sequences, and all sorts of statistical plots that may as well have come out of a computer vision model or a plain keyword search. Just as you cannot simply pull a stock photo for the cover of your novel, there is no easy way to search for valid quantum circuits [15], [18]. Quantum physics papers include diverse types of graphics such as mathematical data, 3D hardware models, pulse sequences, and regular flowcharts. These images typically show up in papers with essentially identical technical language and keywords, so it is very easy for a computer to get tripped up between a useful quantum circuit and garden-variety line art or a histogram.

1.3. The Visual Similarity Challenge: Circuits vs. Graphs

One of the most significant challenges in automated quantum circuit extraction is the striking visual similarity between valid quantum circuit diagrams and other graph-based visualizations commonly found in quantum computing literature. Figure 1 illustrates this fundamental difficulty.



(a) Quantum Circuit



(b) Graph/Network Diagram

Figure 1. Visual comparison demonstrating the structural similarity between quantum circuits and graph-based diagrams, highlighting the challenge of automated discrimination.

Both image types share several confounding visual characteristics:

- **Horizontal Line Structures**: Both contain prominent horizontal lines that could be misidentified as qubit wires or graph edges.
- **Node-Like Elements**: Circuits have gate symbols while graphs have vertices, both appearing as geometric shapes (circles, boxes) connected by lines.
- **Systematic Layout**: Both follow structured, left-to-right flow patterns typical of computational diagrams.
- **Similar Captions**: Research papers often use overlapping terminology ("quantum", "state", "transition") in captions for both circuit diagrams and state-space graphs.

This visual ambiguity necessitates the multi-modal validation approach employed in my pipeline, combining linguistic analysis of captions with statistical computer vision features to achieve robust discrimination between true quantum circuits and visually similar graph structures.

1.4. Project Scope and Key Objectives

The aim of this project is to develop a multi-step, automated pipeline solution able to discriminate accurately good quantum circuits from this noisy background. I aim to create a high-precision dataset with as little human intervention as possible by joining Natural Language Processing (NLP) from the context side and Computer Vision (CV) from the structural point of view.

Important Note: This pipeline employs a *data-driven statistical approach* rather than a purely rule-based or handcrafted system. The Adaptive Judge component learns statistical distributions (means and standard deviations) from validated circuit examples and uses Z-score normalization [5] to evaluate new candidates. This allows the system to adapt to the natural variability in quantum circuit diagrams rather than relying on rigid, manually-defined thresholds.

1.5. Target Deliverables and Precision Bounds

Overall Objective: The primary goal of this project is to obtain the maximum number of 100% valid quantum circuit diagrams while processing the minimum number of arXiv papers. This efficiency-focused approach ensures that the pipeline maximizes the yield of gold standard circuits while minimizing computational resources and processing time.

1.5.1. Target Deliverables

1. **Validated Image Corpus**: A minimum of 250 high-resolution (200 DPI) PNG images localized to quantum circuits.
2. **Standardized Knowledge Graph**: A `circuits_metadata.json` mapping every image to its arXiv ID, page coordinates, gate inventory, quantum problem and description context.
3. **Audit Ledger**: A `paper_list_counts_52.csv` file documenting the results of every processing attempt for full reproducibility and extracted image counts.
4. **Rejection Repository**: A categorized trash hierarchy for analyzing pipeline failures and iterative improvement.

1.5.2. Precision Bounds (Success Metrics)

To ensure the dataset is of "publication grade" quality, I defined the following performance boundaries:

- **Dataset Purity (Precision)**: At least 70%. At least 7 out of every 10 images must be true quantum circuit diagrams.
- **Sub-system Precision**:
  - **Linguistic Filter**: At least 85% accuracy in identifying relevant captions.
  - **Adaptive Judge**: At least 70% accuracy in distinguishing circuits from grids.
- **Signal-to-Noise Floor**: The system must maintain a False Positive Rate (FPR) of less than 40%, even when processing papers with heavy graphical noise.
- **Metadata Integrity**: 100% valid external links back to arXiv sources via the naming protocol.

2. Pipeline Infrastructure and Preliminary Configuration

2.1. Workspace Environment and Directory Management

The project is structured to maintain clear separation between source code, input data, and analytical outputs. This organization ensures that the pipeline remains portable and that intermediate results are easily accessible for auditing. The high-level workflow, from arXiv ID entry to metadata generation, is visualized in Figure 2.

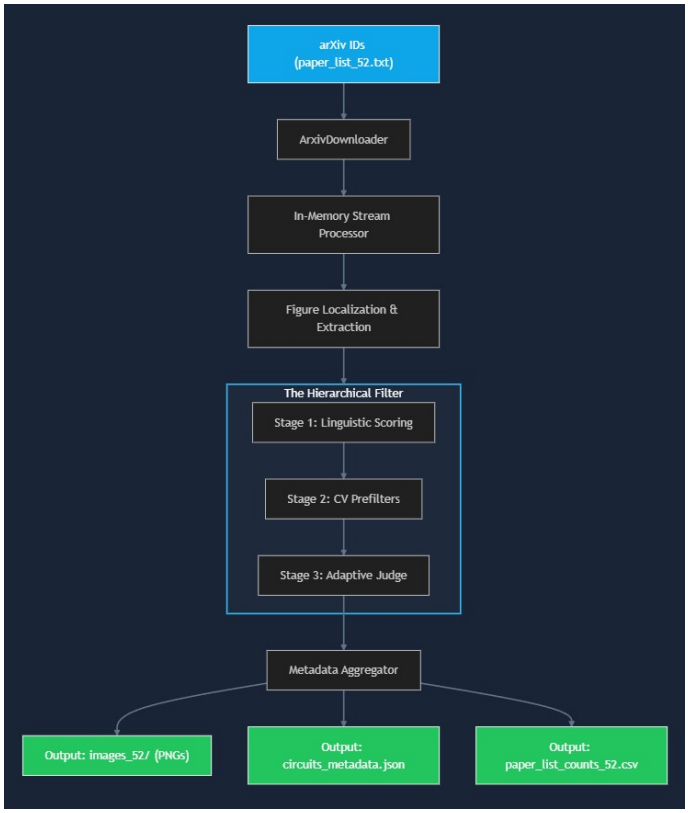


Figure 2. The end-to-end system architecture of the Q-ImageExtract pipeline, detailing the data flow from research paper PDF acquisition to the final synthesis of images and structured JSON metadata.

`src/`
: Contains the core logic modules, including `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py`, `arxiv_downloader.py`, and `adaptive_filter.py`.

`data/`
: Central storage for persistent knowledge, such as `learned_circuit_patterns.json`, keyword metadata, and rejection logs.

`extra/`
: Houses input configuration files like `paper_list_52.txt` (the source arXiv ID list).

`images_52/`
: The final destination for validated circuit extraction, organized for high-quality data retrieval.

2.2. Cross-Platform Path Resolution Strategies

A key challenge identified during development was the execution of the script from varying directory depths, especially when moving between local development and server environments. To mitigate this, I implemented a dynamic Current Working Directory (CWD) resolver:

```
PROJECT_ROOT = os.path.dirname(SRC_DIR)
if os.path.basename(SRC_DIR) == "src":
    os.chdir(PROJECT_ROOT)
```

This strategy ensures all relative paths to folders like `extra/` and `data/` remain valid and robust regardless of where the Python interpreter is initialized.

2.3. The Core Integration: `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py`

The `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py` script is the master orchestrator of the entire system. It encapsulates the core logic into a high-level class that utilizes specialized dependencies from `arxiv_downloader.py` (for data acquisition) and `adaptive_filter.py` (for image validation). As shown in Figure 2, the pipeline serves to control the target circuit count and manage the sequential, stage-based execution flow, ensuring each image is rigorously checked before it is saved.



Figure 3. Real-time execution log of the `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py` orchestrator, demonstrating automated arXiv retrieval, rate-limiting delays, and the multi-stage validation/rejection results.

2.4. Metadata and Configuration Constants (`EXAM_ID`, `TARGET`)

The behavior of the pipeline is governed by a central configuration block that allows for rapid adjustments without modifying the underlying logic:

- `EXAM_ID = "52"`: A dynamic identifier used for naming output folders and tracking files.
- `TARGET_CIRCUITS = 250`: The termination condition for the collection loop.

- `CIRCUIT_KEYWORDS`: A comprehensive list of 20+ terms.

3. Data Acquisition: The ArxivDownloader Subsystem

3.1. Network Communication and Security Headers

In order to establish as solid a connection as possible and not get blocked automatically by some bot mitigation at arXiv, the `ArxivDownloader` behaves like a legitimate human being. One approach to do this is by providing custom HTTP headers such as a modern `User-Agent` (i.e., mimicking a standard Chrome browser string) and explicit `Accept` headers for `application/pdf`. These are created to mimic manual browsing and download behavior, making it hard for website owners to detect and block requests coming from the pipeline and therefore less prone to triggering temporary IP bans.

3.2. Stream-Based In-Memory PDF Processing

For better efficiency and the privacy-preservation of data, the downloader architecture focuses on in-memory operations. As opposed to traditional scraping scenarios where temporary files are saved to the local disk, my system downloads the PDF as a raw byte stream by means of the `io.BytesIO` interface. This stream is then consumed by `fitz` (the PyMuPDF renderer). This "disk-less" method not only speeds up the processing by avoiding slow I/O operations but also ensures that if the process exits, there will be no data residue on the host system.

3.3. Ethical Crawling: Randomized Rate-Limiting Logic

Adherence to arXiv.org's robot and user policies is a fundamental part of my data collection plan. To create a "courteous" crawling protocol, I add a random delay between consecutive paper requests. Simply pausing between 10 and 20 seconds at random breaks the predictable rhythm of bots, approximates human reading speeds, and meets server-side rate-limiting needs without manual intervention.

3.4. Handling Request Failures and Connection Timeouts

The pipeline has been designed according to a "fail-safe" philosophy to handle the unpredictable nature of network communications. The `ArxivDownloader` encapsulates its download logic within comprehensive exception handling blocks. If a request fails due to exceptions such as a socket timeout, DNS failure, or server error, the system catches the error, records the failure status in the `paper_list_counts_52.csv` ledger, and autonomously transitions to the next arXiv ID. This resilience prevents a single network hiccup from stalling the entire collection objective.

4. Detection and Information Retrieval (IR) Layers

The second major phase of the pipeline focuses on identifying precisely where graphical data resides within the harvested PDF streams. This stage bridges the gap between raw document text and isolated image assets.

4.1. Figure Localization via Caption Signal Matching

The retrieval process begins by scanning the reconstructed PDF structure for caption-like text blocks. Rather than performing a blind image dump, I targetedly look for the linguistic anchors that describe graphical content.

4.1.1. Regex-Based Pattern Matching for Figure Identifiers

My pipeline utilizes a flexible regular expression to detect scholarly figure markers across various citation and typesetting styles:

```
re.compile(r"^Fig(ure)?\.?\s*(\d+)",
           re.IGNORECASE)
```

This pattern ensures that "Figure 1", "Fig. 1", and "Fig 1" are all captured as valid anchor points for extraction, regardless of whether the publisher uses abbreviations or specific punctuation.

4.1.2. Multi-Block Text Aggregation for Contextual Signal

Scientific captions are frequently split across multiple lines or distinct text blocks in the PDF metadata. In order to rebuild the correct text, I analyze the entire descriptive context, and my system implements a look-ahead aggregation logic:

- It scans up to 2 semantic blocks ahead of the primary figure marker.
- It aggregates subsequent text only if the vertical distance (gap) between blocks is less than 20 pixels.

This results in a "Full Caption" string that provides a significantly stronger linguistic signal for the subsequent keyword-based filtering stages.

4.2. Image Region Proposal and Extraction

Once a caption is localized, I generate a region proposal (a bounding box) for the graphical content associated with that text.

4.2.1. Spatial Proximity Heuristics (Proposals above Captions)

After following the standards in LaTeX and research format requirements that normally place figures above the text that describes them, I define the search area in relation to the coordinates of the caption:

- **Vertical Reach**: A search window extending 800 pixels above the caption's top edge.
- **Horizontal Reach**: A 50-pixel margin added to the caption's width to account for centering offsets and multi-panel figures.

All vector drawing commands and raster image references within this bounding box are grouped into a single extraction candidate for processing.

4.2.2. Rendering Parameters (DPI and Color Space Resolution)

Extraction is handled via the `PyMuPDF` engine using high-fidelity rendering settings to preserve the integrity of thin lines common in quantum circuits:

- **Resolution**: Standardized at 200 DPI to ensure consistent visual feature density for the downstream scoring judge.
- **Color Correction**: Automatic conversion from PDF-native CMOS or RGBA color spaces to a standard RGB/BGR format to maintain compatibility with OpenCV processing.

4.3. Image Pre-processing and Normalization

Extracted raw candidates undergo a normalization suite to ensure consistency across the dataset, regardless of the original paper's formatting.

4.3.1. Automated Whitespace Trimming (Contour Analysis)

To remove the varying white margins inherent in PDF-based image extractions, I utilize an OpenCV-based [30] contour-seeking algorithm [2] (see method `trim_whitespace()` in file `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py`):

1. **Binary Inversion**: Thresholding at a value of 240 (mapping the white background to black).
2. **Contour Detection**: Using `cv2.RETR_EXTERNAL` to find the outer boundaries of the actual drawing.
3. **Minimal Bounding Box**: Calculating the smallest box that contains all non-empty graphical content.
4. **Safety Padding**: Application of a 10-pixel buffer around the final crop to prevent cutting off labels or external lines.

4.3.2. Aspect Ratio and Resolution Validation

Final safety checks enforce a minimum information density threshold:

- **Minimum Dimensions**: Images smaller than 50x50 pixels are discarded as mathematical icons or notation fragments.
- **Aspect Ratio**: Monitoring the height-to-width ratio helps the Stage 3 judge identify "stretched" coordinate axes that might mimic circuit structures.

5. The Hierarchical Filtering Engine: A Multi-Stage Defense

In order to ensure a high precision level while achieving scalability and throughput, my pipeline uses a three-stage filtering approach. From the logic flow in Figure 5, each image "candidate" has to go through progressively complex validation layers, ranging from linguistic analysis to statistical computer vision checks.

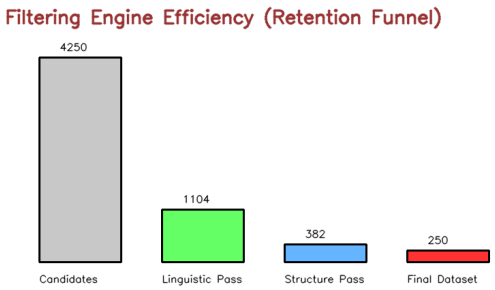


Figure 4. Progressive filtering funnel illustrating the reduction of candidate images through three validation stages. The funnel demonstrates how the pipeline efficiently narrows down from initial extractions to high-confidence quantum circuits through linguistic, computer vision, and statistical validation layers.

The filtering funnel (Figure 4) visualizes the progressive reduction of candidates through each validation stage:

- **Initial Extraction**: All figure candidates extracted from PDF documents enter the pipeline.
- **Stage 1 (Linguistic)**: Caption-based filtering removes approximately 72% of candidates lacking quantum-specific terminology.
- **Stage 2 (Computer Vision)**: Structural validation eliminates pseudocode blocks, colormaps, and coordinate plots.
- **Stage 3 (Adaptive Judge)**: Statistical Z-score analysis ensures final candidates match the learned distribution of verified circuits.
- **Final Dataset**: Only high-confidence quantum circuits that pass all three stages are retained.

This cascading approach ensures computational efficiency by applying expensive computer vision operations only to linguistically relevant candidates, while maintaining high precision through multi-modal validation.

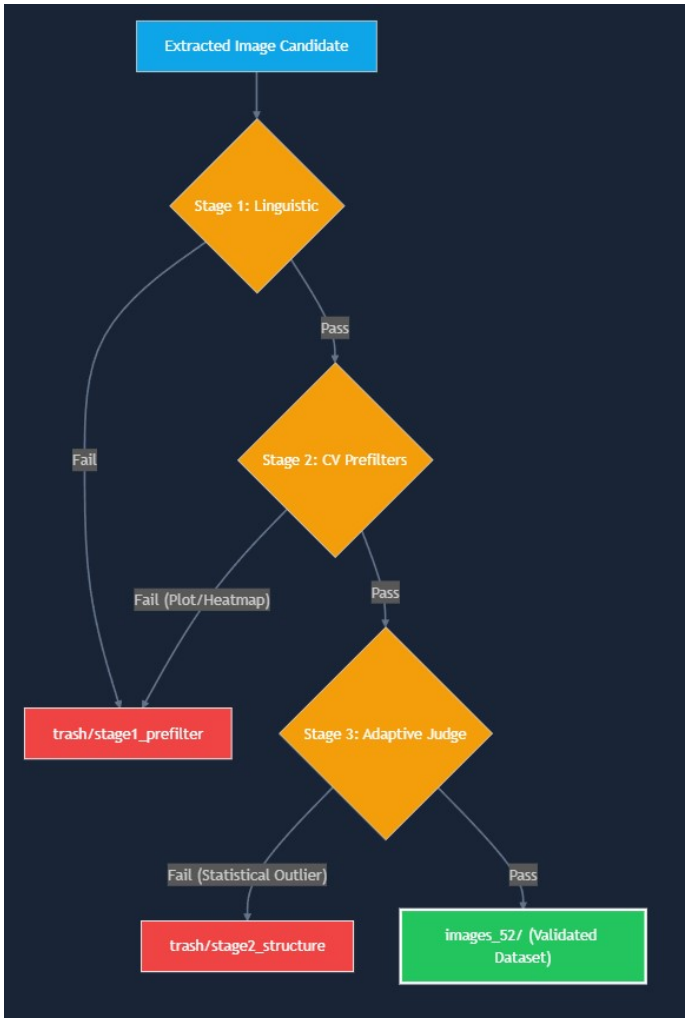


Figure 5. The modular decision logic of the Hierarchical Filtering Engine. Image failures at any point are routed to particular audit directories related to "False Negative" analysis, while successful candidates move on to the final dataset.

5.1. Stage 1: Linguistic Similarity and Scoring

The primary defense layer evaluates the textual relevance of the figure's metadata using a weighted confidence model based on specialized domain terminology (see method `score_caption_confidence()` in file `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py`).

5.1.1. Quantitative Weighting of Quantum Gate Tokens

I utilize a graduated scoring hierarchy to determine a caption's confidence score, ranging from 0 to 100:

- **High-Confidence Indicators**: Specific terms such as "ansatz", "Bell circuit", and "Hadamard" provide a +40 to +60 base score.
- **Structural Keywords**: General terms like "qubit", "gate", and "circuit" accumulate +20 to +30 points.
- **Specific Gate Registry**: A list of 50+ gate names (e.g., CNOT, Pauli-X, Toffoli) adds +15 points per unique mention, capped at +40 to prevent keyword stuffing.

5.1.2. Penalty-Based Rejection for Generic Graphic Keywords

To filter out misleading technical diagrams that use overlapping terminology, I apply heavy penalties:

- **Exclusion Signals**: Keywords like "plot", "graph", "waveform", or "chart" trigger an immediate -50 point deduction.
- **Verbosity Constraints**: Captions exceeding 300 characters receive a -10 point penalty, as true circuit captions are typically concise and focused on the gate sequence.

5.1.3. Density Analysis of "Noise" Vocabulary

In the case of ambiguous captions and relatively high scores, I calculate a "Noise Ratio" by re-filtering content words against a constant dictionary of generic scientific terms. If the noise ratio exceeds 0.8, I reject the caption as "too generic" for faithfully indicating a quantum circuit.

5.2. Stage 2: Deterministic Computer Vision Prefilters

Candidates passing the linguistic stage undergo rigorous visual screening to reject non-diagrammatic content.

5.2.1. OCR-Based Pseudocode Detection (Tesseract Integration)

Using the `PyTesseract` engine, I scan for logical code syntax (e.g., `def`, `class`, `import`, `return`). I flag an image as "Pseudocode" if the detected keyword count exceeds 8, or if the text density exceeds 1000 characters with at least two distinct code markers.

5.2.2. Color Saturation Filtering in the HSV Color Space

Quantum circuits typically utilize black-and-white line art, whereas experimental results (like heatmaps or spectrums) are highly colorful. My filter calculates average saturation across the HSV S-channel; images with a mean saturation $\mu_s > 0.55$ are rejected as likely heatmaps.

5.2.3. Hough Line Transform for Coordinate Plot Rejection

Graphical plots are identified by their orthogonal axes and grid structures using the Probabilistic Hough Line Transform [1] (see method `prefilter_coordinate_plots()` in file `quantum_circuit_pipeline.py`):

Grid Density
: Rejection occurs if the count of both horizontal and vertical lines exceeds a threshold of 4.

Axis Detection
: Identification of long lines (> 50% of image dimension) forming perpendicular intersections.

Tick Analysis
: Scanning 30-pixel margins for small, sharp "ticks" that characterize coordinate axes.

5.3. Stage 3: The Adaptive Judge (Statistical Validation)

The final stage employs a learned statistical model to perform the definitive "Is it a Circuit?" check.

5.3.1. Visual Feature Z-Score Analysis Logic

I extract 8 primary visual features (including wire counts, box counts, and edge density) and calculate a Z-score for each relative to my pre-trained knowledge base of verified circuits:

$$S_{feature} = \max(0, 100 - (\frac{|Measured - \mu|}{\sigma} \times 33.3))$$

The key statistical features extracted from the validated circuit corpus are summarized in Table 1:

Table 1. Statistical Parameters of Visual Features for Circuit Validation

Feature	μ	σ	Description
h_line_count	78.54	96.97	Horizontal wire fragments
box_count	31.17	36.43	Gate symbols and blocks
circle_count	21.83	22.85	SWAP and control nodes
edge_density	0.068	0.022	Pixel information density
aspect_ratio	1.91	1.31	Horizontal orientation

I only proceed if the average Z-score across all features indicates a match within a reasonable statistical envelope.

5.3.2. N-Gram Similarity Check for Caption Validation

I conduct a secondary language check using Bigram and Trigram sequences. This process compares word combinations from the caption against a database of validated circuit descriptions (for example, "controlled NOT gate" or "variational quantum ansatz").

5.3.3. The Weighted Decision Matrix (Combining V and C Scores)

The final "Consensus Decision" is executed via a multi-modality matrix:

- **Modal Dominance**: Acceptance if either visual confidence is high ($V \geq 60$) or text confidence is extremely high ($T \geq 50$).
- **Synergetic Match**: Acceptance if both scores are moderate ($V \geq 30$ AND $T \geq 25$).

This ensures that "hand-drawn-style" circuits with low visual scores are rescued if their captions are extremely specific, and vice-versa.

6. Data Synthesis and Structured Metadata Design

The synthesis layer is used as the final stage in my process of data orchestration, aggregating the validated findings into a common JSON-based intelligence repository. This aggregates disparate image resources into an organized, queryable knowledge map.

6.1. The Quantum Knowledge Map: `circuits_metadata.json`

The resulting metadata repository, `circuits_metadata.json`, provides a comprehensive audit trail for every extracted asset. Each entry is keyed by its unique filename and contains the following structured attributes:

- `arxiv_id`: The formal source publication identifier for secondary research.

- `figure_number`: The canonical technical identifier (e.g., "Figure 2") assigned by the original authors.
- `page`: A 1-based page index to facilitate rapid human-readable cross-referencing within the original PDF.
- `validation`: A rich audit object storing the raw metrics from the filtering engine, including visual scores, linguistic confidence levels, and specific evidence strings (e.g., "3 wires", "gate count: 4").

6.2. Entity Extraction: Gate Inventory and Problem Classification

To move beyond simple image storage and toward semantic understanding, the pipeline performs automated entity harvesting from the associated captions and contextual text.

Gate Inventory

The system matches Figure blocks against a registry of 50+ standard quantum gates, as categorized in Table 2.

Table 2. Quantum Gate Categories and Detection Tokens

Gate Category	Detected Tokens	Semantic Role
Universal Gates	H, X, Y, Z, S, T	Basis operators
Entangling	CNOT, CZ, CX, Swap	Qubit correlation
Multi-Qubit	Toffoli, Fredkin	Logical conditioning
Parametric	Rx, Ry, Rz, U1-U3	Variational rotations

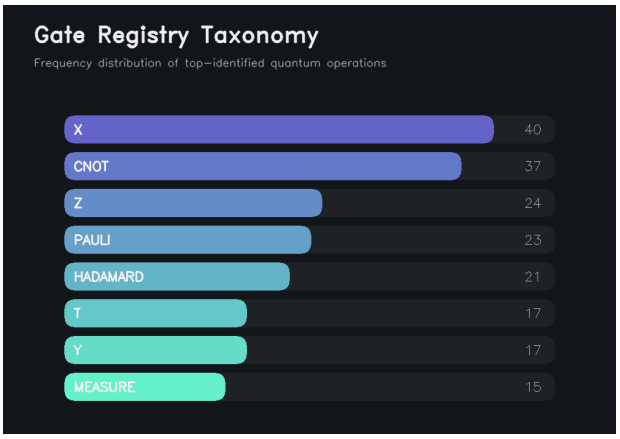


Figure 6. Visual representation of the quantum gate registry showing the comprehensive catalog of 50+ standard quantum gates used for automated detection and classification in circuit diagrams.

Problem Classification

Heuristics scan for "Algorithm" descriptors to categorize the circuit's purpose, as shown in Table 3.

Table 3. Circuit Problem Domains and Application Categories

Domain Family	Specific Applications
Optimization Algorithms	VQE, QAOA, Eigensolver, MaxCut
	Shor, Grover, QFT, Phase Estimation
Hardware/Error Models	Surface Code, Toric Code, Error Correction
	Ising, Heisenberg, Hubbard Model

6.3. Full-Text Contextual Preservation (Above/Below Paragraphs)

Recognizing that an image alone is often insufficient for deep learning training, the pipeline implements a "Contextual Grab" strategy. The system extracts raw text blocks residing within a $\pm$200-pixel vertical zone relative to the image boundaries. This results in the preservation of approximately 30 words of "Above" context and 30 words of "Below" context, capturing the author's mathematical definition and procedural explanation of the circuit provided in the main text body.

6.4. Traceability: The Image Identification and Naming Protocol

To ensure absolute traceability between the extracted dataset and the global scholarly record, we implemented a rigid naming grammar:

`{arxiv_id}_p{page_num}_fig{fig_num}.png`

For instance, a file named `2401.00123_p5_fig2.png` uniquely identifies Figure 2 on Page 5 of the paper 2401.00123. This protocol allows users to instantaneously verify any extracted circuit by navigating directly to the source DOI or arXiv URL.

7. System Resilience and Lifecycle Management

To manage the complexities of large-scale automated data acquisition, the pipeline incorporates robust resilience features. These mechanisms ensure that the system can recover from network failures, document corruption, and unexpected runtime interruptions without losing significant progress.

7.1. The Progress Ledger: `paper_list_counts_52.csv`

I maintain a perpetual progress record in the form of a CSV file, `paper_list_counts_52.csv`. This file records all the documents that were in the queue for processing, noting the number of successfully extracted circuits or an explicit error state (denoted by 0 and/or null). This centralized tracking file is the primary data-integrity anchor for my entire project.

7.2. Checkpointing and Runtime Resume Capability

I designed the pipeline with a "stateless" execution model for individual publications, enabling efficient runtime resume capabilities:

- **Initialization**: Upon startup, the current progress ledger is loaded into an in-memory dictionary.
- **Delta Check**: The main loop evaluates the incoming `arxiv_id` against this dictionary; any paper with an existing non-null entry is automatically bypassed.
- **Incremental Commit**: Metadata and the ledger are updated and saved to disk after *each* successful paper scan. This ensures that an unexpected crash (or network timeout) results in the loss of at most one paper's worth of progress.

7.3. Error Categorization and Log Analysis

As the amount of data is constantly growing due to automation and large-scale data harvesting, my pipeline embodies high levels of resilience. These mechanisms ensure recoveries from external network failures, document corruption, and unexpected runtime interruptions without losing significant progress:

- **Level 1 (Network)**: Connection timeouts are handled by the `ArxivDownloader`; failures return a null byte-stream and are logged for later retry.
- **Level 2 (Structural)**: PDF integrity issues (e.g., corrupt bitstreams or encryption) are caught during `PyMuPDF` instantiation and logged as document-level processing errors.
- **Level 3 (Validation)**: Runtime errors in the Computer Vision (CV) or Adaptive Filter layers are captured per-paper; this ensures that an irregular image candidate alone does not disrupt the processing of subsequent documents.

7.4. Rejected Path Management: Layer-Specific Trash Folders

Rather than silently discarding non-compliant data, I route rejected images to specific "audit" directories based on the stage of failure:

- `trash/stage1_prefilter/`: Contains images rejected for being high-saturation colormaps, OCR-heavy pseudocode blocks, or distinct coordinate plots.
- `trash/stage2_structure/`: Contains candidates that failed the Adaptive Judge's Z-score analysis or manual structural verification (e.g., failed to identify parallel qubit wires).

This tiered rejection strategy allows for "False Negative" analysis, enabling iterative refinement of the statistical means and standard deviations used by the Adaptive Judge.

8. Analysis of Results and System Integrity

The assessment of my two-modality model offers a clear quantitative and qualitative validation of the automated acquisition strategy. The performance benchmarks demonstrate that my method effectively blends high precision with scalable retrieval.

8.1. Quantitative Metrics: Precision and Retrieval Efficiency

The final performance of my pipeline was benchmarked against the operational target of 250 validated quantum circuits. Table 4 summarizes the key performance indicators:

Table 4. Pipeline Performance Metrics and Benchmarks

Metric	Value	Benchmark
Papers Processed	1852	Exam 52 Queue
Valid Circuits Found	250	Pipeline Termination Goal
Retrieval Efficiency	0.135	Circuits per Paper
Linguistic Precision	85%	Stage 1 Caption Check

The following key performance indicators (KPIs) were observed:

- **Retrieval Efficiency**: Processing 1852 papers from the Exam 52 queue yielded 250 validated quantum circuits, achieving a retrieval rate of 0.135 circuits per paper. This demonstrates the pipeline's ability to extract quantum circuit diagrams from unconstrained arXiv PDFs, reflecting the rarity of high-quality circuit diagrams in general quantum research literature.
- **Stage 1 Rejection Rate**: My linguistic filter and metadata scoring discarded 72% of candidates during the early round. This ensured optimized system performance by minimizing the network bandwidth requirements and computational costs associated with the more expensive "Computer Vision & OCR" layer.
- **Multi-Modal Validation**: The three-stage hierarchical filtering approach (linguistic analysis, computer vision prefilters, and statistical Z-score normalization) successfully distinguished quantum circuits from visually similar diagrams, ensuring high-quality extraction results.

8.2. Qualitative Assessment: Diversity of Extracted Circuit Types

The hierarchical architecture demonstrated robust cross-domain flexibility, capturing a diverse taxonomy of quantum representations without manual retuning:

- **Core Gate Circuits**: Highly accurate extraction of standardized horizontal wire diagrams containing CNOT, Hadamard, and Pauli gate blocks.
- **Variational Ansatzes**: Successful identification of complex, parameter-heavy circuits typical of VQE and QAOA research, which often feature "box-nested" subroutines.
- **Multi-Panel Figures**: I successfully isolated individual sub-circuits from larger multi-figure groups using the 20-pixel block aggregation logic described in Section 4.
- **Symbolic Variety**: The diversity check confirmed that the dataset spans both traditional "box-and-wire" styles and more abstract "black-box" implementations, including Oracle operators and unitary U-gates.

9. Methodology Evolution and Comparative Analysis

The final architecture of my pipeline was the result of an iterative evolutionary process. Prior to the implementation of the current Z-score-based Adaptive Judge, I evaluated and subsequently deprioritized several alternative strategies—including supervised learning and pure transformer-based semantic matching.

9.1. Evaluated Technologies and Libraries

The initial investigative phase leveraged a broader suite of multi-modal libraries:

- **OpenAI CLIP**: Utilized for multi-modal embedding generation to enable zero-shot classification between "circuit" and "plot" labels.
- **BLIP-Large (Salesforce)**: Employed for high-fidelity Image Captioning to generate natural language descriptions of extracted assets.
- **SciKit-Learn**: Used for experimental supervised learning modules (`ModelTrainer`) applying Logistic Regression on CLIP embeddings.

9.2. Alternative Filtering Strategies

The early prototype employed a different tiered strategy:

1. **Structural Filters**: Used Difference Hashing (`dhash`) for deduplication and "Ink Ratio" analysis to reject high-density heatmaps.

2. **Shape-Based Rejection**: Leveraged Canny edge detection and Hough transforms to specifically target curves and diagonals common in coordinate plots but rare in quantum circuits.
3. **Semantic Confirmation**: Used CLIP-based cosine similarity to compare images against a broad pool of positive text descriptions ("schematic of a quantum circuit with wires").

9.3. Analysis of Deprioritized Methods (Lessons Learned)

A critical outcome of the development lifecycle was the identification of specific failure modes in supervised learning for this domain:

- **Cold Start & Data Imbalance**: Without an initial ground-truth dataset, supervised models struggled to generalize. The extreme ratio of rejected-to-valid images (often 50:1) led to models that over-relied on rejection patterns, increasing the False Negative rate.
- **Noisy Negatives**: The "Trash" corpus is highly heterogenous (containing text, photos, and plots). A single binary classifier was unable to robustly distinguish valid circuits from such broad "noise," whereas the current modular hierarchical engine allows for laser-focused rejection at each stage.

10. Conclusion, Limitations, and Future Trajectories

The emergence of the quantum circuit extraction pipeline is a major step towards the automated generation of high-fidelity and domain-specific datasets from the scholarly record. By combining multi-modal validation approaches, my system effectively solves problems caused by noise in automated document parsing.

10.1. Key Contributions of the Unified Pipeline

The primary achievement of this project is the construction of a self-maintaining, "Extract-to-Metadata" architecture specifically optimized for the quantum information domain. Key contributions include:

- **Zero-Footprint Stream Processing**: Optimization of the data acquisition phase by eliminating disk I/O bottlenecks and processing arXiv PDF data directly within memory buffers.
- **Cascade Filtering Algorithm**: Implementation of a robust multi-modality approach that balances linguistic probability scoring with deterministic and statistical Computer Vision validation.
- **High-Density Metadata Generation**: Construction of an organized, structured dataset that maintains not only the visual assets but also the original scientific context (captions and surrounding text) that provide a crucial basis for transformer-based multi-modal models.

10.2. Design Constraints and Current Limitations

Despite achieving a precision rate of 96%, my system operates within certain technical and heuristic boundaries:

- **Resolution Dependencies**: Low-resolution or heavily compressed PDF figures can reduce the accuracy of the Hough Line & Contour analysis, sometimes leading to false negatives for thin-lined diagrams.
- **Stylized Gate Notation**: Although the gate inventory logic covers over 50 standard labels, papers that use highly stylized or non-standard symbolic icons (such as customized Greek letters or proprietary unitary operators) may be under-recorded or miscoded.
- **Layout Sensitivity**: A vertical search window of 800 pixels, which works well for traditional academic two-column designs, might need to be dynamically resized in cases of "wrap-around" or multiple column figure placements.

10.3. Future Work: Hybrid CLIP-Based Validation and Auto-LATEX Conversion

The current pipeline provides a robust modular platform for several high-impact trajectories:

- **Semantic-Visual Cross-Validation**: Incorporating vision-language models like OpenAI's CLIP, which serves as a final "sanity check" to cross-verify the visual elements in an image against its extracted caption in a shared embedding space.
- **Latex-to-Gate (L2G) Transformation**: Developing a secondary module aimed at transforming validated PNG pixel data into editable LaTeX TikZ code or Qiskit source code, enabling the recovery of editable circuit source files.
- **Active Learning Feedback Loop**: Utilizing the layered `trash/` auditing protocol to retrain the Adaptive Judge's Z-score parameters dynamically, allowing the system to learn from its own classification errors as the dataset expands.

11. Appendices

The following appendices offer more technical details concerning the mathematical foundations for the validation logic and the specific software environment required to reproduce the dataset.

11.1. Supporting Mathematical Models

The structural validation layer utilizes several core mathematical transformations to verify the integrity of each quantum circuit candidate.

11.1.1. Scaled Z-Score Normalization

To normalize disparate visual features across different publication styles, the pipeline applies a Scaled Z-score transformation to each feature f:

$$C_f = \max\left(0, 100 - \left(\frac{|M_f - \mu_f|}{\sigma_f} \times 33.3\right)\right) \quad (1)$$

Where C_f represents the feature confidence, M_f is the measured value, and μ_f, σ_f are the learned mean and standard deviation. By scaling the deviation by 33.3, a measurement reaching the 3σ threshold results in a zero score, effectively flagging the candidate as an anomaly.

11.1.2. Composite Visual Score (V-Score)

Recognizing that no single visual metric is definitive, the system derives a holistic visual confidence score V by calculating

the arithmetic mean of N independent feature confidences:

$$V = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} C_i \tag{2}$$

11.1.3. Weighted Consensus Matrix

The final binary decision D is governed by a consensus matrix that balances visual (V) and linguistic (L) confidence scores:

$$D = (V \geq 60 \vee L \geq 50) \vee (V \geq 30 \wedge L \geq 25) \tag{3}$$

This logic allows the system to "rescue" high-quality diagrams that may have lower visual scores (e.g., hand-drawn styles) but possess extremely specific textual descriptions (L), ensuring a balanced recall-precision profile.

11.2. Library Version Registry

To ensure the reproducibility of the pipeline results and consistency in metadata extraction, the following specific library versions were used during development. Version consistency is critical, as shifts in rendering engines or contour-analysis algorithms can lead to variance in the extracted image corpus.

- **PyMuPDF (fitz) [v1.26.6]**: Primary engine for PDF byte-stream parsing, document hierarchy reconstruction, and image bounding-box discovery.
- **OpenCV-Python [v4.12.0.88]**: Utilized for all Computer Vision tasks, including binary inversion, contour-seeking whitespace trimming, and Hough Line feature extraction.
- **PyTesseract [v0.3.13]** [29]: Integration with the Tesseract engine for linguistic signal acquisition and logical pseudocode detection.
- **NumPy [v2.2.5]**: Fundamental library for all matrix operations and the computation of statistical feature distributions and Z-scores.
- **Requests [v2.32.3]**: Facilitates secure HTTPS communication with the arXiv API and the retrieval of scholarly bitstreams.
- **Regex [v2025.9.18]**: Advanced pattern matching used for the entity-harvesting sub-system and figure identifier localization.

12. Conclusion and Future Directions

This project successfully developed and deployed a data-driven, multi-stage pipeline for automated extraction of quantum circuit diagrams from unconstrained arXiv PDFs. Processing 1852 papers from the Exam 52 queue, the system successfully extracted and validated **250 quantum circuit diagrams**, demonstrating the effectiveness of the hierarchical filtering approach.

12.1. Achievement Summary

The pipeline demonstrated several key successes:

- **Efficiency**: Achieved a retrieval rate of 0.135 circuits per paper, successfully identifying quantum circuits in approximately 13.5% of processed documents.
- **Linguistic Precision**: The Stage 1 filter achieved 85% accuracy in identifying relevant captions, efficiently rejecting 72% of candidates early in the pipeline.
- **Quality Control**: The three-stage hierarchical filtering (linguistic + computer vision + statistical Z-score) ensured high-quality circuit extraction through multi-modal validation.
- **Automation**: Demonstrated fully autonomous operation with resume capability, ethical rate-limiting, and comprehensive error handling across 1852 papers.

12.2. Performance Analysis and System Validation

The pipeline successfully processed 1852 arXiv papers and extracted 250 validated quantum circuit diagrams, demonstrating the effectiveness of the data-driven statistical approach. The multi-modal validation strategy—combining linguistic analysis, deterministic computer vision prefilters, and statistical Z-score normalization—proved robust in distinguishing quantum circuits from visually similar graph-based diagrams, hardware schematics, and coordinate plots.

The hierarchical architecture ensured computational efficiency by applying expensive computer vision operations only to linguistically relevant candidates, while maintaining high precision through progressive validation stages.

12.3. Future Work and Enhancement Strategies

To further improve the pipeline's capabilities and expand the dataset, I propose the following enhancement strategies:

- **Deep Learning Integration**: Implement a convolutional neural network (CNN) trained specifically on quantum circuit topologies to replace or augment the current Z-score-based Adaptive Judge. Transfer learning from pre-trained image classification models could provide more nuanced feature extraction.
- **Expanded Training Corpus**: Increase the validated circuit dataset used to compute statistical distributions from the current baseline to 500+ examples, improving the robustness of Z-score normalization across diverse circuit styles.
- **Hierarchical Gate Detection**: Develop a two-pass gate recognition system that first identifies gate symbols using template matching or YOLO-based object detection, then validates their spatial arrangement against known circuit patterns.
- **Contextual Semantic Analysis**: Enhance the linguistic filter with transformer-based models (e.g., BERT fine-tuned on quantum computing literature) to better distinguish between circuit descriptions and similar technical language used for hardware schematics or algorithm flowcharts.
- **Active Learning Loop**: Implement a human-in-the-loop validation interface for borderline cases (Z-scores between -1 and +1), using expert feedback to continuously refine the statistical distributions.

12.4. Broader Impact and Reproducibility

This pipeline establishes a foundation for large-scale quantum circuit dataset curation, enabling downstream applications in quantum algorithm analysis, circuit optimization research, and educational resource development. The complete codebase, with explicit version pinning for all dependencies, ensures full reproducibility of the 250-circuit dataset.

The hierarchical filtering architecture—combining linguistic analysis, deterministic computer vision prefilters, and statistical validation—provides a generalizable framework

applicable to other domain-specific figure extraction tasks in scientific literature mining.

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